

council. Prices stayed close to that level in the second quarter—₹1,50,733 per 10 gms, 59% higher than a year earlier—held up by an increase in import duty in May and a weaker rupee.

As a result, Indians are buying less jewellery and paying more. In the first half of 2026, jewellery demand fell 17% to 141.2 tonnes, while value rose 40% to about ₹2.13 lakh crore. Buyers are "opting for lighter, lower-carat pieces and making smaller, less frequent purchases", the council says. In the first quarter, exchanged gold accounted for 40–60% transactions across retailers.

The price of gold is changing how Indians are consuming the precious metal. Demand for bars, coins and exchange-traded funds rose 54% to 82 tonnes in the first quarter, more than the 66 tonnes that went into jewellery, before easing to 54

ICRA expects revenue at alcobev firms it tracks to grow 10–12%, helped by a move towards premium labels